DUKKTAPE STUDIOS

Hero's Journey book template

You don't need it perfect to start.

Fill the blanks. One sentence is enough. Star Wars and Harry Potter are only the shape, not the plot to copy.

When a line is done, tell the Book bot. It will keep this outline and help you write the next beat.

The book in one look

Working title:

Genre (fantasy, thriller, memoir-shaped fiction, etc.):

Who it's for:

One-sentence pitch (When _____ happens, _____ must _____ or else _____.):

Theme (what the hero has to learn, not what happens):

The people

Hero

Name / age:

Ordinary life (before the story starts):

What they WANT (surface goal):

What they NEED (the real lesson):

Flaw or wound that gets in the way:

Mentor (Obi-Wan / Hagrid-then-Dumbledore type):

Villain or opposing force (Vader-Empire / Voldemort):

Ally (Han-Leia / Ron-Hermione):

First obstacle (the thing or person that blocks leaving the old life):

The 12 beats

For each beat: read the two examples, then write your version on "My story."

1. Ordinary World

The hero's stuck, restless life before anything big happens.

Star Wars. Luke is a farm kid on Tatooine, bored and itching to leave.
Harry Potter. Harry lives in a cupboard under the stairs, treated as nobody.

My story:

2. Call to Adventure

The invite, letter, message, or event that says "your old life is over."

Star Wars. The droids show up with Leia's plea for help.
Harry Potter. Hogwarts letters that will not stop coming.

My story:

3. Refusal of the Call

They flinch. Fear, duty, or someone else tries to keep them small.

Star Wars. Luke says he can't leave the farm.
Harry Potter. The Dursleys hide the letters; Harry can barely believe any of it.

My story:

4. Meeting the Mentor

Someone who knows the bigger world and hands over the first tool or truth.

Star Wars. Obi-Wan. Lightsaber, the Force, the truth about Luke's father (as Luke first hears it).
Harry Potter. Hagrid at the hut, then Dumbledore as the longer guide.

My story:

5. Crossing the Threshold

They leave home for real. No going back to the old normal.

Star Wars. Luke leaves Tatooine. Mos Eisley is the doorway.
Harry Potter. Platform 9¾, then Hogwarts.

My story:

6. Tests, Allies, Enemies

New rules. Friends, rivals, small fights. The hero learns how this world works.

Star Wars. Han and Leia, the Falcon, stormtroopers, the shadow of Vader.
Harry Potter. Ron and Hermione, Draco, classes, the first real threats.

My story:

7. Approach to the Inmost Cave

They head toward the true stronghold, secret, or dangerous place. Tension tightens.

Star Wars. Getting onto the Death Star. The rescue is a trap inside the enemy's house.
Harry Potter. The trapdoor, the trials under the school, moving toward the Stone.

My story:

8. Ordeal

The near-death. Something beloved is lost. The old self dies so a new one can start.

Star Wars. Obi-Wan is killed. Luke has to step up without his guide.
Harry Potter. Facing the thing that killed his parents (this first book: the man with the Stone).

My story:

9. Reward

They come out with a prize: an object, a truth, a new identity, a win.

Star Wars. The princess is free, the plans matter, Luke is no longer just a farm kid.
Harry Potter. The Stone is safe. Harry has a place, friends, a world that wants him.

My story:

10. The Road Back

The fight isn't over. They turn toward home or the last battle, with the prize in hand.

Star Wars. The Empire still has a battle station. The trench run is still ahead.
Harry Potter. The year ends. He has to go back to Privet Drive. The war is not done.

My story:

11. Resurrection

The biggest test. They use the lesson, not just the weapon. Almost lose everything.

Star Wars. Luke turns off the targeting computer and trusts the Force. The Death Star dies.
Harry Potter. The last confrontation over the Stone. Love, not power, is what saves him.

My story:

12. Return with the Elixir

They bring something back that changes the ordinary world (hope, belonging, a gift, a truth).

Star Wars. The medal ceremony. The farm boy is a hero. The Rebellion has a chance.
Harry Potter. He belongs. He takes that self home, even if the cupboard street hasn't changed.

My story:

Chapter map (fill after the beats)

Match chapters to beats. Split a beat across two chapters if you need to. Skip a number if two beats live in one chapter.

Ch 1 (Ordinary World):

Ch 2 (Call):

Ch 3 (Refusal):

Ch 4 (Mentor):

Ch 5 (Threshold):

Ch 6 (Tests / allies / enemies):

Ch 7 (Approach):

Ch 8 (Ordeal):

Ch 9 (Reward):

Ch 10 (Road back):

Ch 11 (Resurrection):

Ch 12 (Return):

First page (optional, when you're ready)

Opening image (what we see before anyone talks):

First line I might use:

What I want the reader to feel:

How to use this

1. Fill "The book in one look" and "The people" first.
2. Fill beats 1 to 5 before you write chapter 1.
3. Bring each filled beat to the Book bot and ask it to turn that beat into a scene list or a draft chapter.
4. Do not copy Star Wars or Harry Potter. Steal the spine, invent your world.